

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 25, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 15:1-15

1 David built houses for himself in the City of David; and he prepared a place for the ark of God, and pitched a tent for it.

2 Then David said, "No one may carry the ark of God but the Levites, for the LORD has chosen them to carry the ark of God and to minister before Him forever."

3 And David gathered all Israel together at Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the LORD to its place, which he had prepared for it.

4 Then David assembled the children of Aaron and the Levites:

5 of the sons of Kohath, Uriel the chief, and one hundred and twenty of his brethren;

6 of the sons of Merari, Asaiah the chief, and two hundred and twenty of his brethren;

7 of the sons of Gershon, Joel the chief, and one hundred and thirty of his brethren;

8 of the sons of Elizaphan, Shemaiah the chief, and two hundred of his brethren;

9 of the sons of Hebron, Eliel the chief, and eighty of his brethren;

10 of the sons of Uzziel, Amminadab the chief, and one hundred and twelve of his brethren.

11 And David called for Zadok and Abiathar the priests, and for the Levites: for Uriel, Asaiah, Joel, Shemaiah, Eliel, and Amminadab.

12 He said to them, "You are the heads of the fathers' houses of the Levites; sanctify yourselves, you and your brethren, that you may bring up the ark of the LORD God of Israel to the place I have prepared for it.

13 For because you did not do it the first time, the LORD our God broke out against us, because we did not consult Him about the proper order."

14 So the priests and the Levites sanctified themselves to bring up the ark of the LORD God of Israel.

15 And the children of the Levites bore the ark of God on their shoulders, by its poles, as Moses had commanded according to the word of the LORD.

II. Key Summary

- David prepared a place and pitched a tent for the ark of God in the City of David, and said no one may carry the ark but the Levites, because the LORD had chosen them (v1-2).
 - David gathered all Israel at Jerusalem and assembled the children of Aaron and the Levites; the passage lists the chiefs and numbers of six families (v3-10).
 - David told the priests and Levite leaders to sanctify themselves, saying the LORD broke out against them because they did not consult Him about the proper order; the Levites then carried the ark on their shoulders by its poles, as Moses had commanded (v11-15).
-

III. Passage Analysis

"The Proper Order": How You Do It Counts Too

This demonstrates David's commitment to bringing the ark of the covenant into Jerusalem in the right way. He had learned the lesson that the process also matters to God, not only the result. [1]

In the earlier passage (1 Chronicles 13:7-10), the goal was the same: bring the ark home. But the ark was put on a new cart. In v13 David names the problem, "we did not consult Him about the proper order," so this time the ark is carried on shoulders with poles, as Moses commanded (v15).

David Says "Us"

David rebuked the priests and Levites for not fulfilling their duty, which led to the tragedy. Yet he did not push the blame onto the Levites; he only said they were not there, and so God broke out against "us." In other words, David himself took responsibility for the mistake that led to Uzza's death. [2]

The first half of v13 says "you did not do it the first time," but the second half turns into "the LORD our God broke out against us." David counts himself among the ones who got it wrong.

IV. Reflection Question

The last time you realized you had done something wrong, what did you do next?

After getting it wrong, David admitted "we did not consult Him about the proper order" (v13), then did it again God's way (v15). What gave him the courage to face his mistake was God's grace (1 Chr 13:14).

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 15 – The Ark Is Brought to Jerusalem", <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-15/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Data Website (華人基督徒查經資料網站), Tsai Che-Min et al., Study Notes on 1 Chronicles (1 Chronicles 15), <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT15.htm>